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REPRESENTATIVE OF OVERSEAS NEWSPAPER, NEWS AGENCY OR BROADCASTING ORGANISATION VISA

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REPRESENTATIVE OF OVERSEAS NEWSPAPER, NEWS AGENCY OR BROADCASTING ORGANISATION VISA

The Representative of an Overseas Newspaper, News Agency or Broadcasting Organisation visa category (Media Representative visa) is for employees of media organisations being posted to the UK on a long-term assignment as a representative of their overseas employer.

What is a Representative of an Overseas Newspaper, News Agency or Broadcasting Organisation visa (Media Representative visa)?

The Representative of an Overseas Newspaper, News Agency or Broadcasting Organisation visa (Media Representative visa) allows an employee of an overseas newspaper, news agency or broadcasting organisation to be posted to the UK on a long-term assignment to work as a full-time representative of their overseas employer. Indefinite leave to remain (ILR) can be achieved after 5 years in the Representative of an Overseas Newspaper, News Agency or Broadcasting Organisation visa category.

Requirements for an Overseas Newspaper, News Agency or Broadcasting Organisation visa

In order to qualify for a UK Media Representative visa you will need to satisfy UK Visi Immigration that:

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- You are employed by an overseas media agency or organisation;
- You were recruited outside of the UK; [. \(https://www.google.co.uk/search?q=richmond+chambers+in](https://www.google.co.uk/search?q=richmond+chambers+in)
- (2) You are being posted to the UK on a long-term assignment;
- You intend to work full time for your employer and will not take other work;
- You satisfy an English language requirement;
- Your employer's principal place of business is outside of the UK;
- You will be able to maintain and accommodate yourself without recourse to public funds.

The exact requirements that you will need to satisfy will vary depending on your circumstances. You may want to speak to an immigration lawyer for expert advice.

To discuss your Media Representative visa application with one of our immigration barristers, contact our immigration lawyers on 0203 617 9173 or complete our enquiry form below.

Is the Representative of an Overseas Newspaper, News Agency or Broadcasting Organisation visa only available to journalists?

While Home Office Guidance states that applicants for a Media Representative visa will usually be journalists, it also states that applicants could be producers, news cameramen or camerawomen and front-of-camera personnel. However, secretaries and other administrative support staff will not qualify and must apply under an alternative immigration route if one is available.

How many representatives can an overseas media company post to the UK?

An overseas media company can have more than one representative in the UK. Therefore, the Representative of an Overseas Newspaper, News Agency or Broadcasting Organisation visa can be used to post multiple media company representatives to the UK at the same time.

What documents will I need to provide in support of a Media Representative visa application?

With the exception of the English language requirement, there are no specified evidence requirements for an employee of an overseas newspaper, news agency or broadcasting organisation visa. You will need to prove that you meet all of the requirements above, but the rules do not specify any mandatory requirements in terms of the evidence you must submit. Our immigration barristers can advise as to the documents that should be provided to satisfy the Home Office that the requirements of the visa route are met.

Conditions of Stay as an Employee of an Overseas newspaper, News Agency or Broadcasting Organisation

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As an employee of an overseas media agency, you will not be permitted to take on any other employment and must work full-time for the organisation that you are representing in the UK.

Can a Media Representative bring family members to the UK?

Yes. A Representative of an Overseas Newspaper, News Agency or Broadcasting Organisation may bring, or be joined by, their spouse, civil partner, unmarried or same-sex partner and any children under the age of 18. Unfortunately, as with most other categories of the Immigration Rules (<https://www.gov.uk/guidance/immigration-rules>), Media Representatives cannot bring their parents, siblings or other extended family members.

When should I apply for a Representative of an Overseas Newspaper, News Agency or Broadcasting Organisation visa?

You should make an application for a Representative of an Overseas Newspaper, News Agency or Broadcasting Organisation visa no more than 3 months before you intend to travel.

How much does a Media Representative visa cost?

The Home Office application fee for a Media Representative visa is currently £610.

How long will it take for my Representative of an Overseas Newspaper, News Agency or Broadcasting Organisation visa application to be decided?

Most Overseas Media visa applications are decided within 3 weeks. Many visa application centres outside the UK also offer a priority service which allows Representative of an Overseas Newspaper, News Agency or Broadcasting Organisation visa applicants to receive a decision on their applications for entry clearance within 5 working days.

How can I extend my Representative of an Overseas Newspaper, News Agency or Broadcasting Organisation visa?

Your initial visa will be valid for 3 years, after which time you will be able to extend your stay for a further two years. In order to extend your stay you will need to show that you are still engaged in the employment for which you were granted entry to the UK and are still required for the future. Your employer must certify this in a letter.

Additionally, you will need to show your income for the 12 months before your application to extend. This could be done through providing payslips or bank statements. You can get your employer will need to confirm how your salary was paid, for example, whether it was for a number of hours or if it was commission based.

How can I settle in the UK as a Representative of an Overseas Newspaper, News Agency or Broadcasting Organisation?

After five years in the UK, you may be eligible to apply for settlement provided:

- You have spent a continuous period of 5 years lawfully in the UK as an employee of an overseas newspaper, news agency or broadcasting organisation;
- You have, throughout, been an employee of an overseas newspaper, news agency or broadcasting organisation undertaking a longterm assignment as a representative of their overseas employer
- You have, throughout, been engaged in the employment for which your last period of permission was granted;
- You are still required for the employment in question, as certified by your employer;
- You have demonstrated sufficient knowledge of the English Language and Life in the UK;
- You do not fall under the general grounds for refusal;
- You are not in the UK in breach of immigration laws.

How our immigration barristers can help

The Immigration Rules contain strict requirements in terms of the documents that must be provided in support of a Media Representative visa application. It can be helpful to get advice from an immigration lawyer in order to ensure that your application is professionally presented and technically correct.

Our business immigration barristers have experience in assisting major international newspapers and other media organisations to secure Media Representative visas for their employees. Our barristers are experts in the immigration options available and will guide you through the complex Home Office rules and policies.

We pride ourselves on being approachable and proactive in understanding and meeting our clients' needs. We are a highly driven team, dedicated to providing clear and reliable immigration advice to businesses as part of a professional and friendly service.

WE CAN ALSO ASSIST WITH

Applications for extension of stay as a Representative of an Overseas Newspaper

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WHAT CAN WE HELP YOU WITH?

To discuss your Representative of an Overseas Newspaper, News Agency or Broadcasting Organisation visa application with one of our business immigration barristers, contact our Media Representative visa team on 0203 617 9173 or complete our enquiry form.

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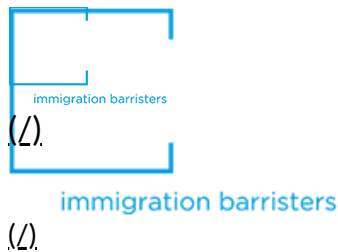
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